

SIA AI Round Table - Topics –

Session 1	Session 2	Session 3	Session 4	Session 5
Where are we now? Mapping current AI & tech adoption across the room	What's holding us back? Diagnosing the real barriers to adoption	What's working? Peer sharing of tools, wins, and lessons learned	What does Practice 4.0 look like? Defining the future-ready architect	What must SIA do? Co-creating the roadmap and SIA action plan

Session 1 Where are we now? — Mapping the current landscape

Establish a baseline picture of how AI and technology are actually being used (or not used) across the architects and firms in the room. Surface the diversity of adoption levels and create a safe, honest starting point for the series.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- On a scale of 1–5, how would you rate your firm's current adoption of AI or digital tools in day-to-day practice? (1 = not at all, 5 = deeply integrated)
- Which AI or technology tools, if any, is your firm currently using? (e.g. BIM, generative design, ChatGPT, Midjourney, Spacemaker — Canva, NotebookLM, Claude,)
- In which part of your workflow has technology made the biggest positive difference so far?
- What does a "typical" working day in your firm look like in terms of digital tools — from project start to drawing issue?
- If you had to describe your firm's relationship with AI in one word, what would it be — and why?

Output: A baseline adoption map across the cohort.

Feeds directly into the AI Literacy Assessment initiative and informs what Session 2 needs to probe.

Session 2 What's holding us back? — Diagnosing the barriers

Go deeper on the friction points. Understand whether barriers are about awareness, skills, cost, client expectations, firm culture, or fear — and which are most common across the profession.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- What is the single biggest reason your firm has not adopted more AI or digital tools? Be specific.
- How much does cost play a role — are the tools too expensive, or is it more about not knowing what to invest in?
- Do your clients encourage, discourage, or have no opinion on AI use in the design process?
- How does your team feel about AI — excited, anxious, indifferent? Where does that sentiment come from?
- What would need to change — in your firm, in the profession, or at SIA — for you to double your use of AI tools in the next 12 months?

Output: A ranked map of barriers by frequency and severity.

This directly informs Session 4's "what does SIA need to do" discussion and the CPD course design.

Session 3. What's working? — Peer sharing of real wins

Shift the energy from diagnosis to inspiration. Let the room hear directly from peers who have made AI or technology work — what tool, what project, what result. Build confidence through evidence from the profession itself.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Share one specific example where an AI or digital tool saved your team time, improved a design outcome, or impressed a client.
- What tool or workflow change made the most difference — and how long did it take your team to get comfortable with it?
- What is the one AI or tech tool you would recommend every architect in Singapore try first, and why?
- How did you or your team learn to use it — self-taught, course, peer, YouTube? What worked best?
- If you could bottle one lesson from your firm's technology journey and share it with the whole room, what would it be?

Output: A curated set of peer case studies and tool recommendations. Becomes a resource in the SIA AI Adoption Report and seeds the CPD course content.

Session 4. What does Practice 4.0 look like? — Defining the future-ready architect

Move from the present to the near future. What skills, mindsets, and tools will define an architect who is competitive and productive in 5 years? What does the profession need to collectively commit to?

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Describe your vision of an architect's typical working day in 2030 — what tasks does AI handle, and what does the architect focus on?
- Which skills — technical or human — will become more valuable as AI takes on more of the routine work?
- What is the biggest risk to the profession if architects do not meaningfully adopt AI in the next 3–5 years?
- What would a "Practice 4.0 ready" firm look like — in terms of tools, team structure, and client offering?
- What is the one competency SIA should prioritise building across its membership above all else?

Output: A shared vision of Practice 4.0 and a competency framework. Becomes the strategic framing for the CPD curriculum and the SIA position paper.

Session 5. What must SIA do? — Co-creating the action plan

Turn 4 sessions of insight into a concrete action plan. Participants co-create the recommendations they want SIA leadership to act on — making them stakeholders in the outcome, not just respondents.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Based on everything discussed across all sessions, what are the 3 most important things SIA should do in the next 12 months to support AI adoption?
- What type of CPD programme would you actually attend — format, duration, topic, level? Be specific.
- Should SIA take a public position on AI in architecture? If so, what should it say?
- What can this group of architects commit to doing — within our own firms — to move the needle on AI adoption in Singapore?
- If SIA does one thing with the insights from this roundtable series, what should it be?

Output: A co-authored action plan and set of recommendations. Synthesises all 5 sessions into the SIA AI Adoption Report delivered to SIA council.